

(From left) **Vivek Shrotiya**, *Additional Managing Director, MP State Tourism Development Board;* **Hareet Kiren Rijiju**, *Union Minister, Earth Sciences;* **Aswini Kumar Patra**, *Tourism Minister, Odisha;* **Mansi N.P. Sivaraj**, *Tourist Officer, Tamil Nadu;* **M.G. Dhanasuryan**, *Assistant Tourist Officer, Tamil Nadu;*

INDIA TODAY Tourism SURVEY & AWARDS 2023

MAKING INDIA

The eagerly awaited INDIA TODAY Tourism Survey & Awards 2023 saw engaging panel discussions on a range of subjects related to tourism. Established as well as emerging tourist destinations from across India were also recognised for their excellence

By Amit Dixit

INDIA TODAY wrapped up another successful edition of the INDIA TODAY Tourism Survey & Awards at the Taj Mahal Hotel, New Delhi on February 29, 2024. The opening remarks by Raj Chengappa, Group Editorial Director (Publishing), INDIA TODAY, set the tone for the day. Backed by data, he talked about the recovery of the travel and tourism sector post-Covid and the road map for the future. The panel discussion titled 'Museums and Tourism: Curating a New Synergy' highlighted the challenges of setting up and funding museums and the catalysing role they can play in rejuvenating tourist destinations. 'Travel and Storytelling: Bikers on the Digital Highway' brought home the insatiable joy of hitting the road on a bike, through the very personal stories of the panellists. The role of the government in promoting tourism is seminal, and the session titled 'From Heritage to Experiential: Revisioning Tourism Strategy in the States' had senior government officials putting forth their points of view on the serious business of tourism.

In a fireside chat with Raj Chengappa, Vinai Kumar Saxena, Lieutenant Governor of Delhi, revealed his plans to boost tourism in the national capital. Kiren Rijiju, Union Minister of Earth Sciences, in a conversation titled 'Rediscovering India', drew attention to how the Himalayan region, including previously restricted border areas, has become more accessible.

Photographs by RAJWANT RAWAT, ARUN KUMAR